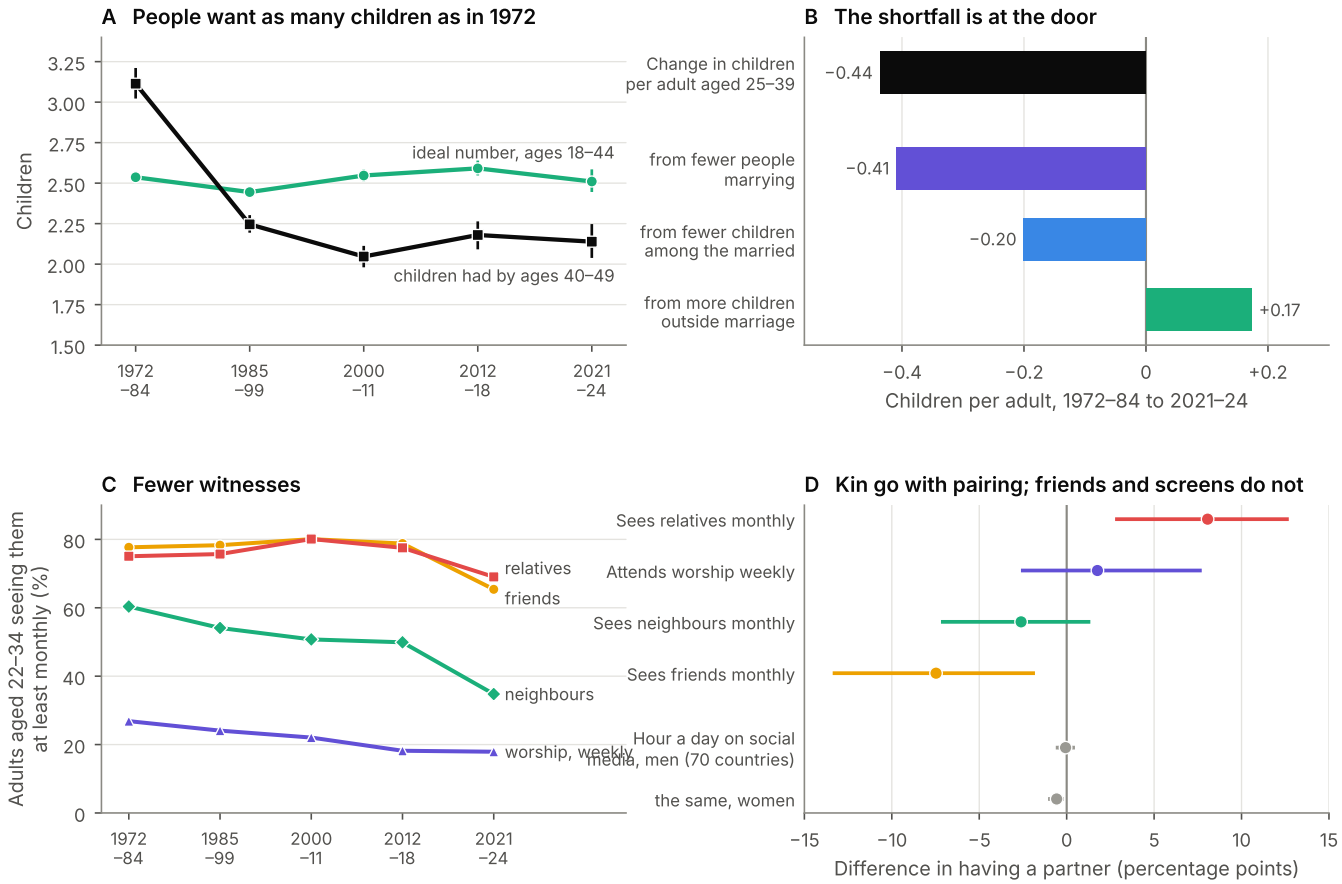
A People want as many children as in 1972
Children
3.25
3.00
2.75
2.50
2.25
2.00
1.75
1.50
ideal number, ages 18–44
children had by ages 40–49
1972–84
1985–99
2000–11
2012–18
2021–24
B The shortfall is at the door
Change in children per adult aged 25–39
−0.44
from fewer people marrying
−0.41
from fewer children among the married
−0.20
from more children outside marriage
+0.17
−0.4
−0.2
0
+0.2
Children per adult, 1972–84 to 2021–24
C Fewer witnesses
Adults aged 22–34 seeing them at least monthly (%)
80
60
40
20
0
relatives
friends
neighbours
worship, weekly
1972–84
1985–99
2000–11
2012–18
2021–24
D Kin go with pairing; friends and screens do not
Sees relatives monthly
Attends worship weekly
Sees neighbours monthly
Sees friends monthly
Hour a day on social media, men (70 countries)
the same, women
−15
−10
−5
0
5
10
15
Difference in having a partner (percentage points)